08.Procurement

Recommandation Report GTN Package

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1 Introduction

This document aims to describe the procurement events, the evaluation of potential contractors and to provide the recommendation of the most appropriate contractor for the supply of the following package for the project: GTN Package .

Substation	Package	Budget Breakdown (EUR)
B1	P08-GTN	289,348.96 €
B2-B4	P08-GTN	289,348.96 €
B3	P08-GTN	289,348.96 €
BIAC	P08-GTN	42,343.75 €
T1-T2-T5	P08-GTN	444,609.38 €
	Total	**1.355.000,-EUR**
	Total, Excl BIAC	**1.312.656,25-EUR**

The allocated budget of this package is **1.312.656,25-EUR** since BIAC was excluded from the scope as the works to be realized need to be performed by SDM in any case since it's a modification on an existing system.

The associated project milestone schedule is:

- Contract award: 2026-03-31
- Start on site: November 2026
- Finalization of Design: January 2028
- Final Provisional acceptance: March 2028

It should be noted that BIAC substation was excluded from the scope and will need to be ordered separately (estimated value of 43kEUR). This was excluded as this will require modification works on the existing control cabinet which will need to be executed by SDM in any case.

2 Recommendation

Based upon the version 3 of the received quotation, SDM Projects scores higher on both the financial criterium and the non-financial criterium. HITACHI has made a significant effort on their price, but still remains 7% higher for the base scope of the project. However, their maintenance contract, change management and hourly rate remain much higher than the ones of SDM (233%). HITACHI updated extensively their "Plan Van Aanpak" and aligned it with the specifications of the RFQ, although they have still not shown correct respect to the project schedule which is very sequenced. SDM has submitted a lump sum offer commitment where HITACHI remains to state conditions in their offer which enable them to submit scope changes (see chapter 5.2). Our final recommendation is to award the contract to SDM Projects.

3 List of candidates

The following candidates have successfully responded to the RFQ:

- SDM-Projects NV
- Hitachi Energy

4 Bid comparison

4.1 Price

Find in annex 1 the comparison table, based upon the Bill Of Quantity, serving as comparison for price. The following observations have been done:

- Posts 1 till 8, representing the base scope, are comparable between both candidates and well within project budget. In revision 2 of the quote, Hitachi was more expensive for both labor cost (7%) and material cost (24%).
- In the revision 3, SDM did not change any priceline. Hitachi made a significant effort on material cost (post for the "Stuurkasten", reducing it's ratio compared to SDM to 70%. At the same time, they increased the cost for manhours resulting in a 122% ratio compared to SDM. For the material cost, no explanation was found
- Manhours weight of the mission was initially 70% for both candidates. Hitachi increased this ration to 82%.

	HITACHI	SDM	HITACHI/SDM
Manhours	€ 496,101	€ 463,400	107%
Material	€ 225,294	€ 182,300	124%
Total	€ 721,395	€ 649,300	111%
Budget Benchmark	55%	49%	
% Manhours	69%	71%	

Figure 1: Quotation Revision 2

	HITACHI	SDM	HITACHI/SDM
Manhours	€ 567,011	€ 463,400	122%
Material	€ 128,368	€ 182,300	70%
Total	€ 695,378	€ 649,300	107%
Budget Benchmark	53%	49%	
% Manhours	82%	71%	

Figure 2: Quotation Revision 3

- Other posts applied for the financial criteria are related to Change Management and OPEX. On these posts, HITACHI's bid is exceeding extremely the bid of SDM and is the main cause for the non-competitive bid of HITACHI. In the revision 3 of the quote, they made a significant improvement but the gap with SDM remains very high (233%).

	HITACHI	SDM	HITACHI/SDM
Onderhoudscontract	€ 314,559	€ 136,652	230%
Eenheidsprijzen - Toevoegen/verminderen van interfaces voor de ontwerpfase	€ 71,370	€ 26,400	270%
Eenheidsprijzen - Toevoegen/verminderen van interfaces voor de assemblage van de borden	€ 94,575	€ 30,425	311%
Eenheidsprijzen - Toevoegen van interfaces tijdens de werken on site	€ 39,181	€ 7,720	508%
TOTAL	**€ 519,685**	**€ 201,197**	**258%**

Figure 3: Quotation revision 2

	HITACHI	SDM	HITACHI/SDM
Onderhoudscontract	€ 272,755	€ 136,652	230%
Eenheidsprijzen - Toevoegen/verminderen van interfaces voor de ontwerpfase	€ 67,785	€ 26,400	270%
Eenheidsprijzen - Toevoegen/verminderen van interfaces voor de assemblage van de borden	€ 90,480	€ 30,425	311%
Eenheidsprijzen - Toevoegen van interfaces tijdens de werken on site	€ 38,440	€ 7,720	508%
TOTAL	**€ 469,460**	**€ 201,197**	**233%**

Figure 4: Quotation revision 3

Also the hourly rates of HITACHI are seriously higher then SDM (23-70%):

	HITACHI	SDM	HITACHI/SDM
Ingenieur	€ 190	€ 155	**123%**
Eplan tekenaar	€ 137	€ 130	**105%**
Programmeerder	€ 190	€ 155	**123%**
Elektricien	€ 156	€ 100	**156%**
Electrician LV	€ 156	€ 90	**173%**
AREI inspectie, inclusief voorbereiding dossier	€ 553	€ 750	**74%**

4.2 Technical Compliance

- Both candidates declared to be fully compliant to the technical specifications of the Request For Quotation. For SDM, an optimization on cybersecurity was requested in version 3. SDM has confirmed to execute with compliance on cybersecurity (NIS2), highlighting also the support within ATS for this topic (specialized department), including:
  - Network switches with encrypted communication and locked unused ports.
  - Limit switches on the cabinet doors which triggers alarm on SCADA/HIFF to detect unwanted “visitors”

5 Project Planning (Plan Van Aanpak)

Black text: Revision 2 of quotation / Green text: Revision 2 of quotation

5.1 SDM

- Simple but clear interaction with electrical contractor
- Good analysis on re-use of existing cabinets
- Good understanding of the project planning and sequence
- Written confirmation of continuation of AVEVA Plant SCADA received
- Written confirmation on cybersecurity compliance (NIS2 compliance), highlighting also the support within ATS for this topic (specialized department)
- No usage of subcontractors
- Schedule is conform for the engineering and manufacturing phase, however following alignment will still be required:
  - A more extensive testing phase on site is declared (4 weeks which ideally should be 2 weeks).
  - Slight alignment needed on B2-B4 schedule
  - Starting date for T1-T2-T7 sequence to be aligned
  - Alignment needed on phases of Fil Rouge part of B1 and B3

  We consider however that these topics can be aligned after contract award.

5.2 HITACHI

Document "Plan Van Aanpak":

Black text: Revision 2 of quotation / Green text: Revision 2 of quotation

- SAT excluded from scope by HITACHI
  - 2 days foreseen in "meetstaat"
- Testing during the night are excluded from the project scope and included in the maintenance contract
  - Plan van aanpak says now:
    - "De 2 de fase (onderbrekeingstesten ?) zal gebeuren bij het omschakelen naar de "life" installatie.
    - Deze testen kunnen tijdens de nacht uitgevoerd worden. Tijdens deze testen worden slechts de
    - basis functionele testen van de automatismes (bij spanningsuitval) overgedaan.
- Black out testing is declared to be done during normal working hours while in the compliance matrix HITACHI declares to perform it during the night
  - 2 x / jaar 's nachts, included in maintenance contract.
- Subcontractor will be used for assembly of the cabinets
  - 2 x / jaar 's nachts, included in maintenance contract.
- Detailed description available of the maintenance contract conditions and scope (to be reviewed by BAC)
  - Not reviewed by IPS
- Missing a description of the coordination effort to be done with the electrical contractor

Document "Technische Offerte : Vervanging GTN":

- Additional configuration of modbus on site will be charged on reimbursable basis:
  - Not changed
- Price for testings only valid when Hitachi personel can is working 6h on site
  - Not changed
- No works outside working hours are included
  - Removed from the document
- Notified Body is only foreseen in the workshop of Hitachi, not on site

- Not changed

- No operator training is included
  - Removed from the document

Document "9.1.3 Plan Van Aanpak-VoorstelPlanning-Rev2":

- The schedule is not understood by HITACHI for the engineering phases. The information from the electrical contractor will be released during the lifecycle of the project and not in one shot as foreseen in HITACHI's proposal.

The revision 3 of the "Plan van Aanpak" is much more extensively decsribed by Hitachi. Many chapters of the Technical Specifications which are part of the RFQ (Bestek) are directly included in the document, mainly documents to supply, test to be performed. The remaining pain point remains the seuqential schedule which is still not integrated in the Hitachi planning. Hitachi has planned to peform all required engineering in 2026 while several inputs to perform their engineering is not available according to the project planning

Document "Meetstaat":

- HITACHI declares to perform only 2 days on site for "IO testen, functionele testen en scada testen van het nieuwe GTN systeem on site". This seems unrealistic low.
  - Not changed